

2. The Four Categories of Computer Hardware

Answer the following questions *in English*. Try and write the exact words you found in the article:

1. How does the article define hardware?

Physical devices that make a computer

2. How many categories of hardware devices are there? What are they and how does the article encapsulate their function?

Input device -> raw data input

Processing device -> process raw data instructions into information

Output device -> disseminates data and information

Storage devices -> data and information retention

3. How is processing described by the article?

The core of a computer (transform raw data into information)

4. How does the article define components of the computer that are categorized under processing?

5. What is the major device in that category? How is its action described?

The microprocessor => works with data stored temporarily in cache and primary memory

6. The article goes on to discuss three important parts of that device. What are they and how are they described?

Control unit => manage and supervise operations

Arithmetic and logic unit (ALU) => all arithmetic and logic operations (+,-,x,/)

Register and cache => Storage locations inside the processor, moving data around during processing

7. How does the article describe output devices?

Disseminate and display data and information

8. How are they categorized? And how are these categories described? Provide a few popular types of each.

Softcopy (intangible) and hardcopy (tangible)

9. How does the article describe storage devices?

Retain data (primary + secondary)

10. How is storage further subdivided?

Primary memory => RAM, volatile (ex : DRAM, SRAM, ROM)

Secondary memory => disk drives, DON'T COMMUNICATE WITH CPU, non-volatile (internal and external)

11. What is the difference between volatile memory and nonvolatile memory?

Volatile memory is released when the power is turned off and not the non-volatile

12. How is secondary memory further subdivided?

Internal and external